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In National League

Season Young But Action Plentiful

By JACK HAND
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The National League took a day off Good Friday after three days of action that produced 341,809 paid admissions, a new manager in Philadelphia and six men hitting .500 or better.

If there was one development that stood out above all others in the first few days it was recognition that Chuck Dressen had taken a firm hold in Milwaukee.

The appearance of Lew Burdette in the bullpen and the quick hook for Warren Spahn on opening day was a solid hint. As soon as Chuck hit Philadelphia for a weekend series, he announced that Spahn, too, would be in the bullpen if needed against the Phils. Juan Pizarro was out there Thursday.

Philadelphia had its largest opening crowd in two years, 32,038, to see acting manager Andy Cohen make the right moves and beat Dressen.

Pittsburgh, regarded as a singles-hitting club without much power, led the league with a .333 club batting average, mostly on the strength of the 13-0 romp over Cincinnati Thursday afternoon. Roberto Clemente, the Pirates' right-fielder, is way out there with a .714 average and six runs batted in for two games. Dick Groat is hitting .625.

Cal McLish, a 19-game winner at Cleveland last year, failed in his first outing for Cincinnati, lasting less than three innings. However, the Reds are happy with Billy Martin's .500 average and the .429 hitting of rookie Tony Gonzalez, the new right fielder.

San Francisco's new park brought a flurry of conflicting reports. First, the wind was so tricky it was believed that nobody would hit a left field homer. Then Thursday night Ernie Banks hit a grand slammer into the cross wind and over the fence as the Cubs won, 6-5. Willie Mays incidentally, is rolling along at a .500 clip.

The Chicago Cubs hoped for new power from Frank Thomas and they got a sample. After going hitless in seven trips, Thomas hit a three-run homer off Los Angeles' Larry Sherry Wednesday night and came through with the winning double off the Giants' Billy O'Dell Thursday night.

Los Angeles won a couple of one-run games and was shut out by the Cubs' Glen Hobbie. After the shutout, Manager Walter Alston benched center fielder Don Demeter and called on rookie Tom Davis in a search for more punch. Sherry lost his first as a starter but gets another try Sunday against St. Louis.

St. Louis was the only non-winner, dropping three straight, 3-1, 6-1 and 3-2, the last one coming Thursday night at Los Angeles. The pitching wasn't bad, except for Vinegar Bend Mizell who was knocked out in the third inning by the Giants, and the wild pitch by relief pitcher Bob Duliba that lost Thursday night's game to the Dodgers. Nobody has been hitting. Daryl Spencer, the ex-Giant, is 9 for 11 and the club average is a sad .163.

Thursday's Late Boxes

CHICAGO AT SAN FRANCISCO

CHICAGO	ab	r	h	bi	SAN FRANCISCO	ab	r	h	bi
Ashburn, cf	4	1	1	0	Blas'ame, 2b	5	1	1	0
T. Taylor, 2b	4	1	1	1	Dav'port, 3b	5	1	2	0
Will, rf	4	1	0	0	Mays, cf	4	0	1	0
Banks, ss	4	1	1	4	McCovey, 1b	3	1	1	3
Thomas, lf	5	0	3	1	Cepeda, lf	4	1	1	1
Altman, 1b	4	0	1	0	Kirkland, rf	4	1	2	1
Zimmer, 3b	5	0	2	0	Bressoud, ss	3	0	0	0
Rice, c	3	1	1	0	Schmidt, c	3	0	1	0
Morehead, p	3	1	1	0	bAmalfitano	0	0	0	0
Elston, p	0	0	0	0	Sanford, p	1	0	0	0
Cec'elli, p	0	0	0	0	Miller, p	1	0	0	0
B. J'nson, p	0	0	0	0	aPagan	1	0	0	0
					O'Dell, p	0	0	0	0
					cLong	0	0	0	0
					dAlou	0	0	0	0
Totals	36	6	11	6	Totals	34	5	9	5

A—Struck out for Miller in 7th; B—Sacrificed for Schmidt in 9th; C—Walked for O'dell in 9th; D—Ran for Long in 9th.

Chicago	004	000	101—6
San Francisco	010	000	130—5

E—Bressoud. PO-A—Chicago 27-7; San Francisco 27-8. DP—Sanford, Bressoud and McCovey; Cepeda and Schmidt. LOB—Chicago 10, San Francisco 6.

2B—Kirkland, Ashburn, Thomas. 3B—T. Taylor. HR—Cepeda, Banks, Kirkland, McCovey. SB—Zimmer. S—Morehead, Amalfitano.

	ip	h	r	er	bb	so
Elston (W, 1-0)	1⅓	1	1	1	2	1
Ceccarelli	⅓	0	0	0	0	0
B. Johnson	⅓	0	0	0	0	0
Sanford	4	6	4	4	1	2
Miller	3	2	1	1	2	2
O'Dell (L, 0-1)	2	3	1	1	3	4

WP—Sanford. O'Dell. U—Landes, Pelekaudous, Barlick, Jackowski. T—3:05. A—32,350.

ST. LOUIS AT LOS ANGELES

ST. LOUIS	ab	r	h	bi	LOS ANGELES	ab	r	h	bi
Grammas, 2b	4	0	1	0	Gilliam, 3b	4	0	1	0
Spencer, ss	3	0	0	0	Neal, 2b	1	0	0	0
Musial, 1b	4	0	2	0	Moon, lf	4	0	0	0
Burton, rf	0	0	0	0	Snider, rf	3	1	1	1
Boyer, 3b	3	1	1	1	fEssegian	1	0	1	0
Nieman, lf	4	0	2	0	gPignatano	0	1	0	0
Flood, cf	0	0	0	0	Hodges, 1b	4	1	2	1
White, cf, 1b	3	1	2	0	Roseboro, c	2	0	0	0
W'ner, rf, lf	4	0	0	0	Davis, cf	3	0	1	0
Smith, c	3	0	0	0	Wills, ss	2	0	0	0
cCrowe	0	0	0	0	aLarker	1	0	0	0
dMiller	0	0	0	0	bLillis, ss	0	0	0	0
Johnson, c	0	0	0	0	hAmoros	0	0	0	0
Kline, p	3	0	0	0	Podres, p	3	0	0	0
McDaniel, p	0	0	0	0	Roebuck, p	0	0	0	0
eSawatski	1	0	1	1	iFurillo	0	0	0	0
Bridges, p	0	0	0	0					
Duliba, p	0	0	0	0					
Totals	32	2	9	2	Totals	28	3	6	2

A—Hit into forceout for Wills in 7th; B—Ran for Larker in 7th; C—Intentionally walked for Smith in 9th; D—Ran for Crowe in 9th; E—Singled for McDaniel in 9th; F—Singled for Snider in 9th; G—Ran for Essegian in 9th; H—Intentionally walked for Lillis in 9th; I—At bat for Roebuck when winning run scored in 9th.

St. Louis	000	100	001—2
Los Angeles	000	000	102—3

E—Spencer. PO-A—St. Louis 25-11; Los Angeles 27-14 (one out when winning run scored in ninth). DP—Willis and Hodges; Grammas, Spencer and Musial; Neal, Lillis and Hodges. LOB—St. Louis 7, Los Angeles 7.

2B—Musial. 3B—Hodges. HR—Boyer, Snider. SB—White. S—Roseboro.

	ip	h	r	er	bb	so
Kline	6⅓	4	1	1	3	2
McDaniel	1⅔	0	0	0	1	1
Bridges	0	1	1	1	0	0
Duliba ((L, 0-1)	⅓	1	1	1	2	0

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